

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

CONTENT

- Let's Start! • Let's Explore! • Let's Practice! • Extension Activity • Target Words • Learning Points



Let's Start!

There's a new opportunity at work. What is it?



Learning Outcome

Accurately use important information about people's jobs and places of work in communicative situations.

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about jobs and work.
- I can make and respond to suggestions.
- I can show flexibility.

Ask your partner:

- What is the best way to respond to suggestions?
- How can you show flexibility at work or school?





Let's Explore!

Janet gives Peter more responsibility at work. Is she jeopardizing a **critical opportunity*** or she is being **too soft****?

* An important opportunity.

** "Too soft" means too quick to agree, or too pleasant.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Janet: Hi Miranda. Have a seat. I must say I was impressed with your presentation. Thank you!

Miranda: It was fun to do. I think we all benefited.

Janet: Yes. Poor Ferdinand couldn't look at me when you discussed punctuality! He and Peter seemed to enjoy their scenario together. Speaking of Peter ... I'm thinking he might be a good candidate to write the proposal for Farmani.

Miranda: Are you suggesting Peter Smith?

Janet: I am. I'm thinking it might be a good idea to get him to do it. He's pretty keen.

Miranda: I agree.

Janet: Do you have any concerns?

Miranda: It's not a bad idea. It's just that, well, he struggles with deadlines. What do think about Greta?

Janet: She's on the ball but lacks experience.

Miranda: True, but wouldn't you like to give her a chance?

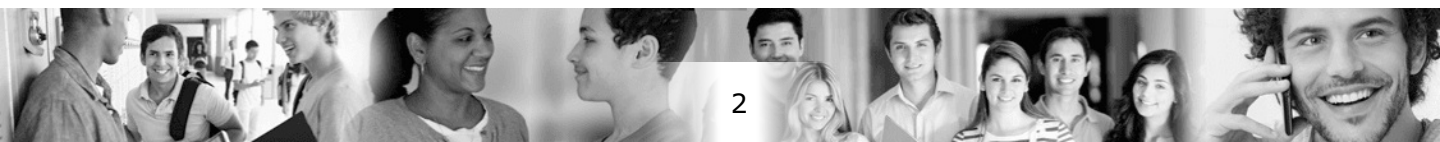
Janet: All in good time. Too much is counting on this proposal. Miranda, you didn't need me to refuse Peter time off now. You're too soft. You know, Peter will be inspired by this opportunity and do a good job but he might need a little boost to keep up his momentum. I think you could give him a scare now and then.

Miranda: Like threaten his job?

Janet: Whatever it takes.

Miranda: I'll take it into consideration. Are you sure we might not be jeopardizing a critical opportunity?

Janet: I would never run the risk. I would just suggest you take a firm approach with Peter when necessary. He can produce.





Let's Practice!

Miranda makes an offer. How does Janet respond?

Instruction: Read the dialogue again. Select all the words or phrases that are making or responding to suggestions.

Janet: I'm thinking he might be a good candidate to write the proposal for Farmani.

Miranda: Are you suggesting Peter Smith?

Janet: I am. I'm thinking it might be a good idea to get him to do it.

Miranda: I agree. It's not a bad idea. Well, I'll take it into consideration. But, are you sure we might not be jeopardizing a critical opportunity?

Janet: I would never run the risk. I would just suggest you take a firm approach with Peter when necessary.



Let's Practice!

Who shows flexibility? Janet or Miranda?

Instructions: Read the paragraph. Complete the paragraph. Use the Word Bank options.

Word Bank

be willing to

you say so

All in

be jeopardizing

Are you sure

any concerns

Are you suggesting

time

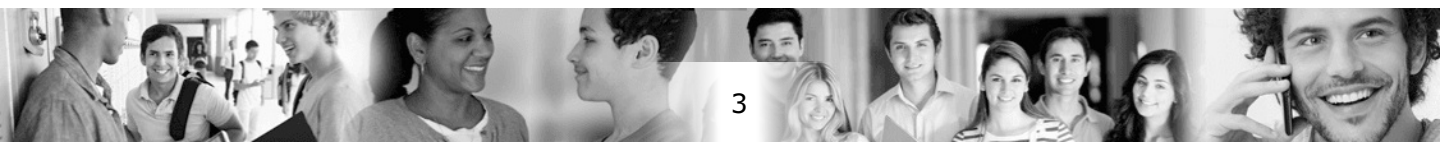
If _____. _____ we might not _____ a major opportunity?

_____ good _____.

_____ Peter Smith?

Do you have _____?

I'd _____ give Greta a chance.





Extension Activity

Let's have a business meeting.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Work with a partner. Imagine that one of you is the manager of company. The other is the manager of a small department.
- Have a meeting to suggest some changes to the company.
- Remember to use language necessary for making and accepting suggestions.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I use language appropriate for a business meeting.

☐ ☐

I make and accept suggestions in a meeting.

☐ ☐

I talk about jobs and work.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- keen** (adjective): wanting to do something
e.g. Peter is very keen.
- on the ball** (expression): alert to new ideas or methods and quick to react
e.g. Greta is on the ball.
- all in good time** (expression): in time with no risk of being late
e.g. Everything will work out, all in good time.
- to count on** (verb): to rely or depend on someone or something
e.g. There's too much counting on this proposal.
- whatever it takes** (expression): doing anything that is necessary in order to achieve a goal
e.g. You need to do whatever it takes to make sure the job is done.
- to jeopardize** (verb): to risk harming or destroying something
e.g. I think we'll be jeopardizing a critical opportunity.
- run the risk** (expression): allowing the chance for harm or loss
e.g. I would never run the risk of ruining the business.





Learning Points

Making and Responding to Suggestions

In the business world, at times, you have an idea, a recommendation or plan that you think could work for your company. It is important to use proper language to offer those ideas for someone to consider. Here is some language you can use for making and responding to recommendations.

Making Suggestions	Responding to Suggestions
You might ... * You might want to ... * I would suggest ... * It's generally best/a good idea to ... * I'm thinking it might be a good idea to ... * I'd like to suggest/recommend ... * Why don't we ... ? <i>* These expressions are followed by a bare infinitive (verb without 'to')</i> In my experience, ... ** works really well. Have you tried ... ? ** <i>** These expressions are followed by a noun or -ing form.</i>	That's not a bad idea. I agree. I like the sound of that. That's a good idea. This sounds great. That would be great. I'll take it into consideration.

More on "suggest"

It is important to remember that when 'suggest' and the verb that follows it have different subjects, you use the pattern: "suggest + that + someone + should + do something"

Example:

I suggest that Peter should tell Miranda that he is going to write the proposal.

Examples:

- **I'm thinking it might be a good idea to** have him write the proposal.
- **I would suggest** you keep an eye on him if necessary.
- **He might** need a little push to get work done.





Learning Points

Showing Flexibility

In the workplace, it is important to show others that you are able to make changes or deal with situations that are constantly changing. You may need to adapt to different people and circumstances. It's an important trait in any employee and a vital quality. So here are some ways in which you can show flexibility.

- Are you suggesting ... ? (+ *-ing*)
- Do you have any concerns?
- All in good time.
- If you say so.
- I'm easy.
- Are you sure?
- We might be jeopardizing (+ *noun*)
- I'm open to ... (+ *verb*)
- I'd be willing to ... (+ *verb*)
- I'm okay with ...

Examples:

- **Are you suggesting** asking Peter to do it?
- I have some ideas, but **I'm open to** suggestions.
- I don't think it's appropriate, but **if you say so**.

